

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Did you read the manual? Do you need to call the hotline?



Learning Outcome

Explain about technology and technical problems in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can ask for help or advice.

Ask your partner:

- Do you read operation manuals before you start using an electronic device? Why or why not?
- Have you ever called a hotline for help on technical problems? Were they able to solve your problem?





Let's Explore!

Vanessa gets all the technical assistance she needs from the **hotline***.

* A "hotline" is a special number you can call to get technical assistance or for emergencies.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Rachel:** Hello? Vanessa? Are you still on the line?
- Vanessa:** Yes, I'm still here. I really need this router to work! I've done everything you suggested, but there is no signal improvement. I've read the instructions manual, but it's all Greek to me!
- Rachel:** Let me tell you how to troubleshoot this issue. Did you try rebooting your computer? The problem might come from your laptop's Wi-Fi component.
- Vanessa:** Can you tell me what to do to see if that's the case?
- Rachel:** First, you should power down your computer for a few minutes. Wait until it has completely cooled down. Then, you should switch it on again and check the quality of the signal.
- Vanessa:** Hang on, you're going too fast.
- Rachel:** No worries. You might want to write this down. If it still doesn't work, you could try downloading the latest version of the Wi-Fi driver.
- Vanessa:** Could you tell me what to do if it still doesn't work?
- Rachel:** I would upgrade to a newer Wi-Fi component. You should be able to get it for free if your computer is under warranty.
- Vanessa:** That sounds like a lot of trouble. Hang on! The router works now!
- Rachel:** Fantastic!
- Vanessa:** Yeah. Thanks so much for your help!





Let's Practice!

Technical jargon* is Greek to Vanessa!

*"Jargon" means a set of words or expressions difficult to understand.

Instructions: Spell the mystery word. Organize the letters to find out what the hidden words are.

1. brteoo _____

6. tawrnrya _____

2. dwopornwe _____

7. ododanlw _____

3. vsoenir _____

8. onntecpom _____

4. eroholtsbtuo _____

9. iervdr _____

5. areugpd _____



Let's Practice!

Is Vanessa getting all the help she needs?

Instructions: Complete the questions with the words below.

Word Bank

- where
- how
- how long
- what
- if

1. Can you tell me _____ to do to see if that's the case?

2. Could you tell me _____ I must wait before switching the computer on again?

3. Can you tell me _____ to troubleshoot this issue?

4. Do you know _____ I can download the latest driver?

5. Could you tell me _____ my computer is under warranty?



Extension Activity

Write troubleshooting instructions.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find instruction manuals for devices that you use every day.
- Look for the FAQ (frequently asked questions) and the troubleshooting section.
- Write your own troubleshooting manual (10 - 14 lines). Think of 4 technical problems you want to solve.
- For each problem, provide a solution using modals or expressions suggesting advice.
- Read your partner's troubleshooting manual. Ask for clarification if you don't understand how to deal with your partner's technical problems.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about technology and technical problems.

☐ ☐

I offer advice and suggestions to deal with technical problems.

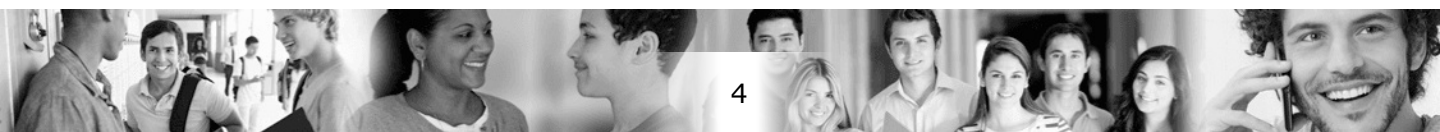
☐ ☐

I ask for clarification about technical problems.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- It's all Greek to me!** (expression): I can't understand anything at all!
e.g. I've read the instructions manual, but it's all Greek to me!
- to reboot** (verb): to start a computer again after a problem
e.g. Did you try rebooting your computer?
- to power down** (verb): to shut down an electronic device completely
e.g. You should power down your computer for a few minutes.
- version** (noun): a particular form of software different from earlier forms of the same thing
e.g. Which router software version do you have?
- to download** (verb): to copy data from the Internet into a computer
e.g. You could try downloading the latest version.
- warranty** (noun): a period during which repairs on a device are made free of charge
e.g. You should be able to get it for free if your computer is under warranty.
- to troubleshoot** (verb): to fix an electronic problem
e.g. Let me help you troubleshoot this issue.
- to upgrade** (verb): to get a newer version of something
e.g. I would upgrade to a newer router.
- component** (noun): a piece of electronic equipment
e.g. The problem might come from your laptop's Wi-Fi component.
- driver** (noun): a program that runs particular tasks in a computer
e.g. Make sure you have the latest version of the Wi-Fi driver.





Learning Points

Dealing With Problems: Giving Advice

One way to discuss how to deal with problems is to say what you would do if you were in someone else's situation. It is particularly useful if you want to discuss a complicated technical problem.

If you have a conversation about technical issues, you can use modals like *would*, *should* or *could* to suggest solutions and offer assistance.

I would ...

I wouldn't ...

You could ...

You might want to ...

You must ...

Always check ...

These are examples of a technical assistant giving suggestions about how to deal with technical problems.

Examples:

- *First, you should power down your computer for a few minutes.*
- *Wait until it has completely cooled down.*
- *You might want to write this down.*
- *If it still doesn't work, you could try downloading the latest version of the Wi-Fi driver.*
- *I would upgrade to a newer W-Fi component.*





Learning Points

Discussing Problems: Asking for Help or Advice

There are several ways to ask for help in English. You can use polite and casual language to do this. Let's look at one particular structure for asking for help.

You can use the structure:

Can/Could/ Do + you + verb + me (optional) + question word

Can you show me how this computer works?

Could you tell me where I can download the latest driver?

You can also suggest advice by using the same structure:

Do you know where to go online to download the driver?

These questions suggest solutions related to technical issues. They are often used in user manuals or troubleshooting booklets.

Modal Can/Could/Do	Subject	Verb	Question Word
Could	you	tell (me)	what to do?
Can	you	show (me)	how to check if it's working?
Do	you	know	how to reboot your computer?
Do	you	know	where you can download the latest driver?

You can also use the structure

Let me show/ tell + you + question word

Let me show you how to make this computer work.

Examples:

• **Ann:** *Could you tell me what to do if the router still doesn't work?*

Bob: *Let me tell you how to troubleshoot this issue.*

